New Zealand Rogaining Association Inc.

President's Annual Report 2018/19

This has been another year of strong growth for rogaining in New Zealand. We now have more events than ever before. In the calendar year of 2018 I personally took part in more than 140 hours of rogaining and enjoyed every minute of it.

The New Zealand rogaining association is a volunteer-based organisation. We owe great credit to our members, particularly to Matt Bixley who designed the New Zealand Champs course in Dunedin - arguably one of New Zealand's toughest 24 hour championships on record. It was certainly the wettest! No world championship was held in 2018, however New Zealand was well represented in Australia with a strong contingent of Kiwi's heading over for the Australasian Champs. Ex-President Peter Squires and teammate Anne Kennedy won the Mixed Ultra-Veteren Grade.

Rogaine results from New Zealand and around the world have had a major upgrade this year thanks to the efforts of local resident (and current world champion) Greig Hamilton. His website (rogaine-results.com) features some very clever programming and analysis, which can provide almost as much entertainment to the rogainer as the event itself!

The New Zealand Rogaine Association supports both community and commercial events. With an increase in the number of rogaines there is an ever-present competition for participants. We must maintain our efforts to reach new rogainers and grow the community as a whole. I believe the NZRA is well placed to support the promotion of the sport in a wider sense and should extend our efforts towards producing high-quality content to support this growth.

This AGM marks the retirement of Trevor Merrifield (Treasurer) and Colin Dixon (Secretary). Both active rogainers, I would like to thank them both for their contribution to the sport and our committee. Trevor has made a substantial contribution as NZRA treasurer over over more than ten years and has supported me as a mentor over this time. Colin and race partner Douglas Woods are planning this year's Height's of Winter rogaine in North Canterbury. I would like thank then both for their continued support to the his continued support.

Entries are open now for the 2019 New Zealand Rogaine Championships, set for November 23-24th at a location near Ranfurly. This will be a qualifying race for the 2022 World Championships in yet to be announced location. Notwithstanding the 'championship' nature of the event I encourage all rogainers in New Zealand to set the date aside and take part in this shared experience. I look forward to seeing you there.

Tim Farrant, President